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GRDA Opens Tema-Mpakadan Railway Line to Private Sector Operators Under New Open Access Model

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The Ghana Railway Development Authority (GRDA) announces that it is now ready to admit private sector operators onto the Tema–Mpakadan Railway Corridor under a new Open Access and Private Sector Participation model, opening Ghana's newest standard gauge freight line to qualified investors and operators.

Under the model, private companies will be able to acquire and deploy their own locomotives to operate freight services on the 97-kilometre Tema–Mpakadan line, running alongside GRDA's own freight operations. Interested operators will pay GRDA an annual access fee of GH¢ 1,000,000 for a five-year term to run their locomotives on the line.

As part of the arrangement, GRDA will be responsible for the maintenance of participating operators' locomotives, and will provide qualified drivers and wagon operators to run services on their behalf allowing private operators to invest in rolling stock while GRDA continues to safeguard the technical and operational standards of the corridor.

Key Terms of the Open Access Model

Term	Details
Corridor	Tema–Mpakadan Railway Line (97 km)
Access Fee	GH¢ 1,000,000 per year
Track Access Charges	To be determined
Term	5 years
Rolling Stock	Acquired and owned by the private operator
Locomotive Maintenance	Provided by GRDA
Drivers & Wagon Operators	Provided by GRDA

This initiative reflects GRDA's commitment to broadening private sector participation in Ghana's railway sector, unlocking additional freight capacity on the corridor, and accelerating the shift of containerized cargo from road to rail between the Port of Tema and the eastern and northern hinterlands.

GRDA invites shipping lines, logistics companies, and private investors interested in operating their own locomotives on the Tema–Mpakadan corridor to engage the Authority's Strategic Initiatives and Business Development Directorate for further details on the Open Access model, eligibility requirements, and the application process.

For enquiries, contact the Strategic Initiatives and Business Development Directorate at info@grda.gov.gh.